

PocketSmart – Set Up Google Cloud Account and Enable Gemini API (Gemini AI Initialisation)

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1. Topic

Setting up a Google Cloud account and enabling the Gemini API

Epic: Gemini AI Initialisation

2. Project Overview

PocketSmart is an AI-powered app that helps users track spending, set budgets, and get personalized money-saving suggestions. It uses Google Gemini AI to analyse spending data and generate insights, so the Gemini API must be set up and ready before the AI features can work.

3. Objective

To create and prepare a Google Cloud account, enable the Gemini API, generate a secure API key, and confirm that the key works so it can be used in the PocketSmart backend.

4. Work Steps

- 1 Sign in with a Google account and open the Google Cloud Console.
- 2 Accept the terms and set up the Google Cloud account (billing details may be needed for some services).
- 3 Create a new project for PocketSmart and select it as the active project.
- 4 Open the API Library and enable the Gemini API (Generative Language API) for the project.
- 5 Open Google AI Studio (or the Credentials page) and create an API key linked to the project.
- 6 Restrict the API key if possible, for example to the Gemini API only.
- 7 Store the key in a .env file as GEMINI_API_KEY and add the .env file to .gitignore so it is never shared.
- 8 Install the Gemini SDK in the project and load the key from the environment.
- 9 Send a small test prompt to confirm the API responds correctly.
- 10 Add error handling for missing or invalid keys and note the usage limits and quotas.

5. Main Parts of the Setup

- Google Cloud account creation
- Project creation
- Enabling the Gemini API
- API key generation and restriction
- Secure key storage in the environment file
- SDK installation and test request
- Error handling and usage limits